Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

Thursday 11 June 2026
Morning (Time: 1 hour 30 minutes)

PAPER REFERENCE
1HI0/33

History

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

Sources/Interpretations Booklet

Do not return this Booklet with the question paper.

Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.
This booklet contains Source B, Source C, Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 for use with Question 3 on the question paper.

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Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.

Sources for use with Questions 3(a) and 3(c).

Source B

Source B: From the 'Southern Manifesto' (Declaration of Constitutional Principles) signed by 101 Southern members of Congress in March 1956.

We regard the decision of the Supreme Court in the school cases as a clear abuse of judicial power. It climaxes a trend in the Federal judiciary to legislate, in derogation of the authority of Congress, and to encroach upon the reserved rights of the States and the people. We pledge ourselves to use all lawful means to bring about a reversal of this decision which is contrary to the Constitution and to prevent the use of force in its implementation.

Source C

Source C: From a speech by a leader of the Montgomery White Citizens Council in Alabama, speaking to a segregationist rally in 1956.

The Negroes think that a court ruling can force us to integrate. But we hold the economic power in this town. If they continue to demand integration, they will find themselves without jobs, without credit at our banks, and without homes. We will organize economic boycotts against any business that surrenders, and we will use every social pressure to protect our segregated Southern way of life.

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Interpretations for use with Section B.

Interpretations for use with Questions 3(b), 3(c) and 3(d).

Interpretation 1

Interpretation 1: From a modern historical study.
Opposition to civil rights in the late 1950s was highly organized and politically entrenched, successfully stalling desegregation. By signing the Southern Manifesto, Southern congressmen created a unified political front that legitimized defiance. At the local level, White Citizens Councils waged economic warfare, firing Black workers and denying them loans. This combination of political resistance and economic terror effectively delayed integration for years.

Interpretation 2

Interpretation 2: From a different historical perspective.
Although Southern opposition was loud and politically unified on paper, it ultimately failed to halt civil rights progress. The extreme nature of the opposition's resistance and local violence actually backfired. It shocked Northern public opinion and forced a reluctant federal government to intervene, culminating in the passage of the Civil Rights Acts of 1957 and 1960. These laws established the vital precedent of federal voting rights protection.

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